7 December 2025 — קריאת התורה, קדושה דסידרא, and למנצח מזמור לדוד

Independent review · read fresh, from the finished HTML only (as delivered, before part-3 corrections) · 25 October 2026

1.Overall Read

A nine-section write-up (roughly 3,700 words of body plus a twenty-two-note *Mareh Mekomos* apparatus of about 2,400 words) on the end of *Shacharis* after the Torah reading. The spine is clear: why a blessing for every *oleh* (I–II), *HaGomel* at the reading (III), the lost *Yehi Ratzon* (IV), *Ashrei* (V), the *Aruch HaShulchan* (VI), and the history of *Lamnatzeach* (VII–IX). The movement from the reading to *Lamnatzeach* is natural and the ending, the blessing to one's neighbor, is the right one. The hard editorial issues are six: (a) the chapter count of *Tehillim* in IX contradicts fn 20; (b) a Hebrew date in the header that does not match the Sunday; (c) a note attributed to the *Ketzos HaChoshen* in the margin of a *Gemara*; (d) the voice of oral delivery throughout ("last *Shabbos*," "I dedicate this shiur," "above my pay grade," "*you* correctly added"); (e) section VIII, which carries three digressions (the legend, Lucena's cemetery, Nikolsburg) under a heading about *Beis Rabbeinu*; and (f) an apparatus that still carries working notes ("Verify exact citation") and several unsupported biographical claims.

2.What Works

- **The latecomer paragraph (II).** "*Chazal* do not say that [he is lazy]… They are sensitive to him" is the right pitch: a real insight, short, practical.

- **The bank account of merits (III).** The *Shalmei Nedarim* pearl is set up with a question (“no parallel anywhere”), answered in two sentences, and the *bris* parallel is handled in one parenthesis.
- **The structure of V.** The *Gemara* → two reasons → *kavanah* → why twice at *Shacharis* → why before *Kedushah*, each with its own subheading. A reader can enter anywhere.
- **The *Aruch HaShulchan* on the closing *Ashrei* (VI).** The Otisville detail earns its place: it is the image the point needs. “We fed our *neshamah*; now we feed our *guf*” is the best sentence in the document.
- **The legend callout (VIII).** A good use of a callout: a real aside that points back to the main line (*Natronai* and Spain).
- **Footnote hygiene.** Twenty-two notes in body order with matching back-links, short/expanded format consistent, Hebrew inline throughout.

3.Where It’s Weak or Could Be Sharper

Section IX contradicts its own footnote. The body says “our *nineteenth* perek of *Tehillim* is, in the older count, the *twentieth*,” and then that after the eighteen comes “perek .”כ Fn 20 says “our perek 20, originally perek 19.” With chapters 1 and 2 merged, the older number is one *less*, not more. The subheading (“The Connection to ”קפיטל כ is right and the body wrong.

Section V cites the wrong sage. The callout “A המוהה קצוות החושן places a note “in the margins of the קצוות החושן own gemara, in what became known as the Vilna ש״ס The marginal notes printed in the Vilna *Shas* are the *Gilyon HaShas* of Rabbi Akiva Eiger; the *Ketzos HaChoshen* is a commentary on *Choshen Mishpat*. Also the claim that the *Rosh*’s text does not say “three times a day” is unsourced, and the callout says “we do not rely on this” without saying whom “we” are.

The header Hebrew date. The meta line reads “ז׳ כסלו תשפ״ו · 7 December 2025.” By calculation (Chanukah begins the evening of 14 December, so 25 Kislev is 15 December), 7 December 2025 is 17 Kislev. A learned reader will notice. The kicker says “Sunday Morning,” which is correct for 7 December.

The voice. The text moves between a sefer voice and the voice of the speaker. “I dedicate this shiur” (callout, III), “Last שבת we shared a beautiful pearl,” “(You correctly added the parallel…)” (addressed to a congregant), “The exact reason is above my pay grade,” “my wife’s grandfather,” “My family has a tradition of ten generations,” “My older brother researched it carefully.” For a printed edition these need either a speaker label (“the Rav,” as the Sefer Edition does) or removal.

Section VIII is overloaded. Its heading is “בית רבינו שבבבל,” but under it come the order of prayer, the first mention of *Lamnatzeach*, the legend, and two paragraphs on Lucena’s end and the Nikolsburg fence. The last two are a separate topic and could stand under their own subheading or in a box. Their closing lines (“Everyone else is relegated to Wikipedia”) are the lecturer’s flourish and sound like it. The Nikolsburg paragraph begins “The same in Nikolsburg” with nothing to be “the same” as the preceding tombstone story, and gives no source for “Spanish law for centuries.”

A garbled sentence. In III: “The מזמור stride alongside the קרבן built right in.” It does not parse. The point appears to be that the thanksgiving is discharged within the reading itself, as an offering is; say that.

The personal aside on Rav Menashe Klein (II). A long parenthesis names a living family’s grandfather, a dispute over the Boro Park *eruv*, and mockery of a title. The point is a good one (we do not mock *gedolim*), but the apparatus is heavy for the place and exposes private names. Consider moving the moral to a sentence and the names to a note.

4.Factual / Citation Concerns

The *Elisana* etymology (VII). The write-up has “אלי סנא the Spanish way of saying ‘no, no.’” with no explanation of why a Jewish city would be named for “no.” Almost certainly a corruption; the plain reading is that the name is אלישנה a rendering of a Hebrew phrase. Needs the original.

Fn 4 (Bava Kamma 82a). “*Chazal* attribute the original *takkanah* to Moshe at Mei Marah” is stated without a citation; the passage cited does not obviously say it. Hedge or source.

Fn 18 and 22 (*Yerushalmi Berachos* 5:1). The same chapter and *halakhah* is cited for two different statements (the hour before and after; blessing one who finishes praying). Both cannot be taken without a closer look; fn 22 ends “Verify exact citation in ירושלמי ברכות ה. 5,” a

working note left in the text. Also fn 18 has the early pious come “before” and “after” in one sentence quoted as a single *Yerushalmi* line; the *Mishnah* in Berachos 5:1 has only the hour before.

Fn 14 vs. the body (VI). The body: “forty-five to fifty years as the רב of a real קהילה.” Fn 14: “for over 35 years.” Also “(his exact contemporary)” for the *Mishnah Berurah* sits beside dates (1829–1908) that are not the *Chofetz Chaim*’s. Reconcile or attribute the figure to the lecturer.

Fn 19 label. “הלכות תפילה פ"ד ה"ט"ז,” should read ט"ז, and “citing the ירושלמי” is garbled (“ירושלמי is not borne out by the halakhah.

Fn 16. “He wrote more than 30 תשובות” is the lecturer’s claim and should say so; the “ed. Brody, Jerusalem 1994, Yad HaRav

Herzog” publisher should be checked; the “earliest mainstream documentation” is an overclaim.

Fn 5, 8, 11. “(1923–2011),” “a תלמיד of the Satmar Rebbe,” “among the standard פרושים on the מסכתא” and “records a tradition that…” are all uncited. Fn 11 claims the *Machzor Vitry* “records a tradition” with particulars the shiur does not give.

The quotation in III. The verse is given as ויודו לה' חסדו… בקהל עם ובמושב זקנים יהללוהו. The first words are the refrain of *Tehillim* 107 (vv. 8, 15, 21, 31); the clause that follows is verse 32 (“ויהוממוהו). It reads as one verse.

5.Small Polish Suggestions

- Unify transliteration: *yid*/*yidden*/*davening*/*shul* are sprinkled through; the subtitle says *Birkos ha-Olim* while headings use ברכות העולה.

- “The ׳ה should open His hand” (VI): the article before the Name is odd; “Hashem should open His hand.”
- In fn 21 “see fn 22” should be a link; the same for other cross-references.
- “*Ready to receive.*” and “*Where are they running to?*” are italicized as if quoted; use the same device each time.
- The closing section is a single sentence (“We will continue next week”); either expand to a two-line summary or drop the heading.
- Give the legend callout its own footnote (it has none); the same for the Lucena newspaper story.
- The lead should say what the piece does not reach (the rest of *Lamnatzeach*).

6.Bottom Line

> *A readable, well-ordered write-up whose best moments (the latecomer, the bank account of merits, the Aruch HaShulchan on the closing Ashrei) are real Torah and well placed. It needs one mechanical pass for its few firm errors (the chapter count, the Ketzos HaChoshen, the Hebrew date, the voice), one structural fix (section VIII), and a hedging pass over an apparatus that states biographical details no source in hand supports. With those done it can stand as a sefer chapter.*

Produced by an independent editorial pass reading the finished HTML only, without the transcripts. Reviewer brings the perspective of a learned general reader familiar with the standard *siddur*, *Shulchan Aruch Orach Chaim* and the *Gemara* in *Berachos* and *Megillah*.